

What the public record shows

Before an irreversible closure, show the complete plan and the complete math.

The fiscal problem is real. That does not make every proposed solution sound. The public needs to know what changed, what was tried first, and what Landers actually saves after every offsetting cost is counted.

HOW WE GOT HERE - USE THE RELEVANT FIVE-YEAR BASELINE

2021-22 baseline Immediately before Dr. Vargas took office in July 2022, CDE Census Day enrollment was 7,580 - not the old 10,000-student peak. The 2022-23 budget overview projected \$147.20 million in revenue and \$145.84 million in spending: about \$1.36 million more revenue than expenditures.

2025-26 CDE reports 7,305 students: 275 fewer than the 2021-22 baseline, a 3.6% decline. The Enrollment/7-11 Committee nevertheless reported a roughly \$7 million operating deficit, about \$4 million structural after one-time costs.

Committee recommendation Adjust boundaries first. Keep closure as a last resort until viable enrollment, retention, attendance, and operational-efficiency strategies are fully implemented and evaluated.

August 25 The Board returned to closure scenarios, with Landers advanced for consolidation into Yucca Mesa.

LANDERS SAVINGS PUBLISHED BY MUSD

These are gross personnel figures. They are not a complete net closure model.

TIER 1	TIER 2	TIER 3
\$368,512 Core site office / library	\$629,378 Adds custodial and supervision	\$908,176 Adds deeper student-support cuts

THE SCALE QUESTION: WHERE ELSE WAS MONEY MODELED?

MEASURE	MUSD	COMPARISON / SCALE
CADIE - unrestricted admin spending	\$1,230 per ADA	\$836 peer average
CADIE - total admin spending	\$1,520 per ADA	\$978 peer average

CADIE context. A parent analysis of the district report calculated about \$3.5 million in annual administrative spending above eight geographic peers. CADIE measures expenditures per ADA; it is different from SABRE compensation benchmarking.

SABRE context. The 2024-25 report lists superintendent compensation at \$292,560 over 245 days. On June 16, 2026, the Board approved senior-management salary actions while closures remained under discussion.

ONE DISTRICT LEVER: MUSD's Budget Stabilization Review estimated that a one-percentage-point attendance gain could bring about \$880,000 annually - nearly the published Tier 3 Landers personnel figure.

MEASURE C AND THE COMMUNITY

Landers appears in district facilities planning and the Measure C project discussion. Districtwide property-tax levies continue even if a campus closes. The public should receive a written accounting of what was promised, scoped, budgeted, contracted, completed, cancelled, or reallocated at Landers.

WHAT SHOULD EXIST BEFORE THE SEPTEMBER 10 HEARING

A recommended tier - a recurring net-savings model - transportation cost and route times - Yucca Mesa capacity, class sizes, and added staffing - family-loss/ADA sensitivity - a Landers Measure C accounting - a written record of alternatives tried and measured.

If those documents are not public before the hearing, families are being asked to react to a conclusion without being allowed to examine the model behind it.

SOURCE NOTES CDE Census Day enrollment; MUSD 2022-23 LCFF Budget Overview; MUSD Enrollment/7-11 Committee Final Report (6/8/26); MUSD personnel-savings table (8/25/26); MUSD Budget Stabilization Review (4/30/26); CADIE/SABRE figures summarized in Desert Trumpet (6/20/26); Measure C project materials.

12 QUESTIONS THAT REQUIRE SPECIFIC ANSWERS

Each person can take one. Read the fact; ask the question; request a number, document, assumption, or date.

1. WHICH SAVINGS TIER IS REAL?

FACT MUSD published three Landers personnel figures: \$368,512, \$629,378, and \$908,176.

ASK Which tier should the Board and public actually use, and why?

2. WHICH POSITIONS LEAVE DISTRICT PAYROLL?

FACT Transferred employees do not create districtwide payroll savings.

ASK Name every position eliminated - not transferred or refilled elsewhere - under the tier you are recommending.

3. WHAT IS THE NET ANNUAL SAVINGS?

FACT The published table counts personnel only.

ASK After transportation, receiving-site staff, maintenance/security, relocation, and transition costs, what is the recurring net savings? Publish the line-item model.

4. HOW MANY FAMILIES CAN MUSD LOSE?

FACT Closure math assumes Landers students remain enrolled and generate funding at the receiving school.

ASK Show net savings if 5%, 10%, or 20% of Landers families leave MUSD. What is the break-even attrition rate?

5. WHERE DOES THE REST OF THE \$3.5 MILLION GO?

FACT Landers has been described as costing roughly \$3.5 million to operate, but even Tier 3 claims under \$1 million in personnel savings.

ASK Which costs follow students, which remain fixed, and which truly disappear because the campus closes?

6. WHICH ALTERNATIVES WERE IMPLEMENTED FIRST?

FACT The Enrollment/7-11 Committee called closure a last resort after enrollment, retention, attendance, MTSS, ACCE, and efficiency strategies are implemented and evaluated.

ASK List each strategy, start date, cost, measurable target, result, and why it was judged insufficient.

THE STANDARD FOR AN ANSWER A number. A document. An assumption. A date. If the answer is 'declining enrollment,' ask the question again.

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7. WHY NOT REBALANCE BOUNDARIES FIRST?

FACT The Committee's first recommendation was districtwide elementary boundary adjustment.

ASK What boundary scenarios were modeled for Landers, what savings or utilization gains did each produce, and why were they rejected before closure?

8. WHY RAISES DURING A FISCAL CRISIS?

FACT The Board approved senior-management salary actions on June 16 while school closure and staffing cuts were under consideration.

ASK What is their four-year cost, and why were they approved before requiring equivalent central-office reductions?

9. WHY IS ADMINISTRATION ABOVE PEERS?

FACT The CADIE-based parent analysis reports \$1,230 unrestricted admin spending per ADA versus \$836 among eight geographic peers, and \$1,520 total versus \$978.

ASK What explains each gap, and what central-office reduction scenarios - with dollar totals - were presented to the Board?

10. WHAT DOES SABRE TELL THE BOARD?

FACT SABRE lists MUSD superintendent compensation at \$292,560 over 245 days for 2024-25.

ASK What enrollment-size and rural peer group did the Board use, and how did that evidence affect compensation and cabinet staffing decisions?

11. WHAT HAPPENS TO MEASURE C COMMITMENTS?

FACT Families were asked to support the facilities bond, and property owners continue paying it while Landers appears in district project planning.

ASK What Landers work was promised, scoped, budgeted, contracted, completed, cancelled, or reallocated - and how is continued taxation equitable if the school closes first?

12. WHAT MUST BE PUBLIC BEFORE A VOTE?

FACT The Sept. 10 hearing is meaningful only if people can examine the assumptions before speaking.

ASK Will MUSD publish the net model, transportation plan, receiving-site class sizes/capacity, staff impacts, attendance-risk scenarios, Measure C accounting, and alternatives record before any Board decision?